

FactoryLM: Path to Beta Testers

Go-to-Market Strategy for MIRA | June 2026

Walker Reynolds vs. Mike Harper: Two Paths to Market

Walker Reynolds spent 6+ years building community BEFORE shipping software. YouTube whiteboard videos since 2018, coined 'Unified Namespace,' built an 8K Discord, 400+ paying Mastermind members at \$297/mo, a conference (Provelt! with 1,500 attendees in 2026), then UNS Studio arrived into a market he already owned. His beta testers ARE his community.

You cannot replicate 6 years. But you do not need to. Walker sells the architecture vision. You sell the maintenance floor result. Different buyer, shorter sales cycle. Walker needs architects and integrators who understand UNS. You need maintenance managers who have a stack of manuals and a problem at 2 AM.

Your Specific Advantages Right Now

Advantage	Detail
4K LinkedIn followers	Maintenance professionals (hydraulic enthusiasts group). Dormant but recoverable. Research says you need
30 years on the floor	You speak maintenance, not IT. Edmund's founders are software people learning maintenance. You are the o
367 leads in HubSpot	45 Central Florida cities. Local prospect pipeline nobody else has built.
Working product	app.factorylm.com is live, Telegram bot answers real questions, knowledge graph exists, Ignition integration w
Real equipment	Garage conveyor with Micro820 + GS10 VFD + real sensors + Ignition. Not a simulation.

How Competitors Got Their First Beta Testers

Company	Strategy	Lesson for MIRA
MaintainX	Free mobile app for technicians. Bypassed IT gatekeepers.	Consumers grow better with free single platform adoption
UpKeep	Solo founder Ryan Chan built a free iOS app. Grew through Apple's list of free apps.	Start free. Let the list spread. The only competitor.
Edmund AI	12 months co-developing with factory customers before design.	Design patterns in real factory. Expand through the factory.
Walker / UNS Studio	8K Discord + 400 Mastermind members IS the beta.	Software arrives, into an existing community with floor credibility

What 'Beta Ready' Actually Means

For a maintenance platform, you need **ONE core flow** working end-to-end. You do NOT need a full feature set, polished branding, billing, complete documentation, or a perfect UI. You need one wow moment that makes a tech say 'holy shit, it found the answer in my manual.'

Requirement	Status
Technician can log in (or open Slack/Telegram)	READY
Technician asks a question about their equipment	READY
MIRA answers with grounded evidence from real docs	READY (but upload gap blocks new docs)
The answer cites its sources	READY
Zero-training onboarding	NEEDS WORK (onboarding flow exists but untested)

What Is Blocking Beta Readiness Right Now

- 1. Upload-to-retrieval gap** -- PDFs uploaded do not become citable in chat. A beta tester uploads their GS10 manual and asks 'what does fault F0004 mean?' -- if MIRA cannot cite the manual they just uploaded, the demo fails. This is the #1 blocker.
- 2. Knowledge graph page crashes** -- PR #1742 fixes it (NaN coordinate guard). Needs merge + deploy.
- 3. Ignition Ask MIRA not turned on** -- needs HMAC key in Doppler + WebDev module on PLC laptop. 30 min of ops.
- 4. Empty state for new tenants** -- new users log in and see blank pages. Needs demo seed data.

The 4-Week Plan to First Beta Testers

Week 1: Fix the One Flow That Matters

Fix the upload-to-retrieval gap so uploaded manuals are citable in chat. Merge + deploy the knowledge graph crash fix. Seed a demo tenant with real conveyor data. Record one 3-minute video: 'I uploaded a GS10 VFD manual and asked MIRA what fault F0004 means. Watch.'

Week 2: Re-engage LinkedIn

Post the video with: 'I have been building this for 2 years. It reads your maintenance manuals and answers questions about your equipment. Looking for 10 maintenance professionals to try it free for 30 days.'

DM 20 of your most engaged hydraulics followers personally: 'Hey [name], I built something I think you would find useful. Can I show you a 5-minute demo?'

Post a war story from your 30 years -- a time you wished you had this tool.

Week 3: Design Partner Program

Offer 5-10 'design partners' free access for 90 days in exchange for: uploading 2-3 of their own manuals, using MIRA on one real troubleshooting scenario, and giving you 15 minutes of feedback.

Frame it as: 'Help me build the tool you wish existed when you were on the floor at 2 AM.'

Use the \$500 assessment as a paid alternative for anyone who wants hands-on setup.

Week 4: Local Plant Visits

Pick 3-5 from your 367 HubSpot leads that are closest geographically. Call them: 'I am a 30-year maintenance guy who built an AI tool that reads your manuals and helps your techs troubleshoot. Can I show you in 15 minutes?'

Bring a tablet with the Ignition Ask MIRA demo running on the conveyor bench.

The Honest Gap

Walker has community (8K Discord, 400 Mastermind, conference). You have floor credibility (30 years, real equipment, real problems). His path took 6 years. Your path can be 6 weeks if you fix the upload-to-retrieval gap and post that first video.

You do not need a Mastermind or a conference. You need 10 maintenance managers to upload their manuals and say 'this actually works.'

Realistic Timeline

Milestone	When	Depends On
Upload-to-retrieval fix deployed	Week 1	Code fix (PR #1592 + routing)
Demo video recorded + posted	Week 1-2	Fix deployed + seed data

First 5 LinkedIn DM responses	Week 2	Video posted + personal outreach
First design partner uploads their manual	Week 3	Onboarding flow works
First 'holy shit' moment from a stranger	Week 3-4	Their manual + their question = good answer
10 active beta testers	Week 4-6	Word of mouth from first 5
First \$500 assessment sold	Week 6-8	Beta tester referral or LinkedIn lead